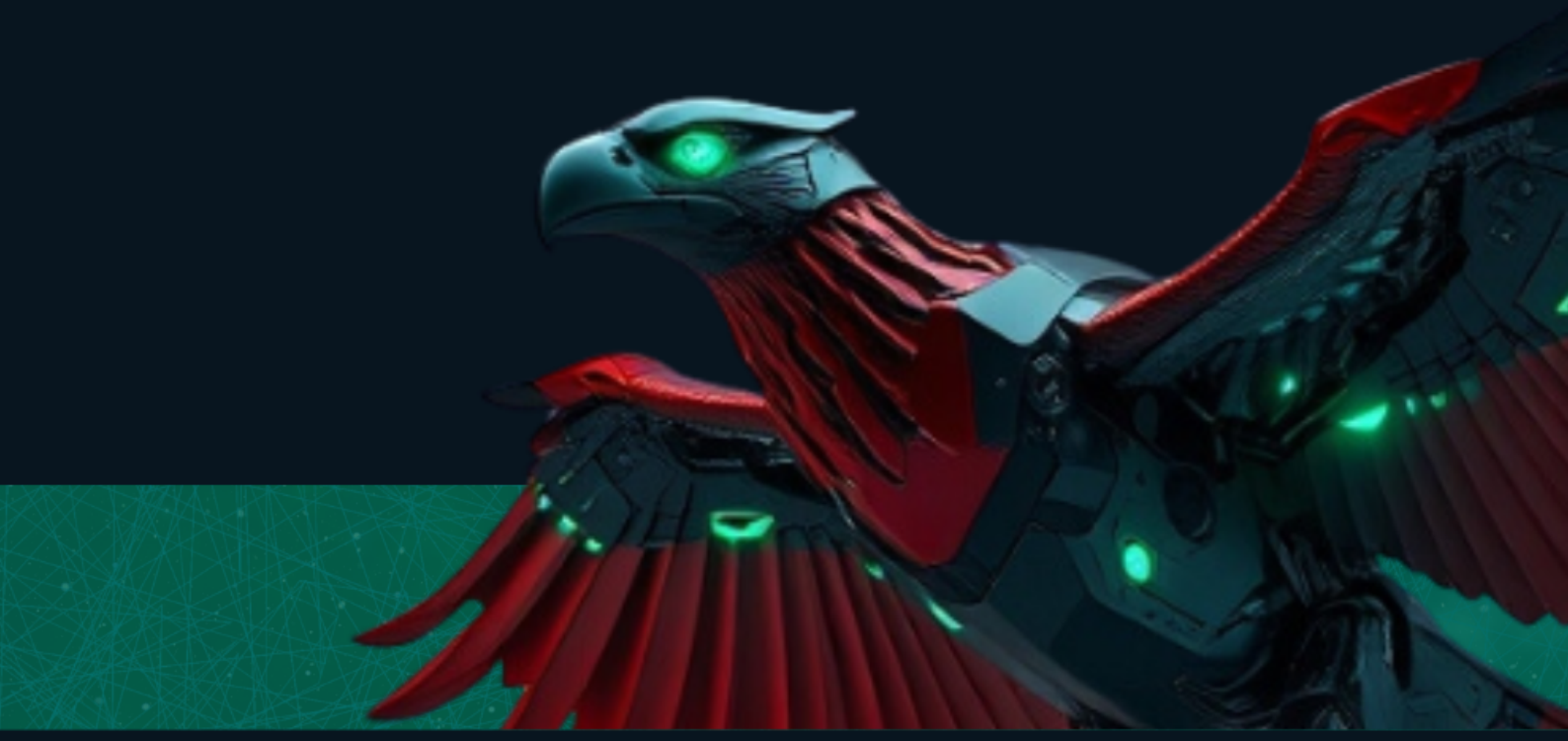
SOCBYTE
ALL BYTES SECURED

INTEL REPORT



Report Details

Title	Threat Advisory | CVE-2026-0257
Sub Title	Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Authentication Bypass Vulnerability
Status	Closed
Type	Advisory
Severity	—
Source	US News
Created At	Jun 09, 2026, 01:37 PM

Threat Advisory | CVE-2026-0257

Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Authentication Bypass Vulnerability

Type: ADVISORY • Source: US News • Created At: Jun 09, 2026, 01:37 PM

Analysis Summary

The vulnerability designated as CVE-2026-0257 is a critical security flaw affecting Palo Alto Networks' PAN-OS software, specifically targeting devices configured with the GlobalProtect portal and gateway where authentication override cookies are enabled. This vulnerability stems from an authentication bypass mechanism (classified under CWE-287). The flaw allows remote, unauthenticated attackers to circumvent standard validation procedures and gain unauthorized access to the network infrastructure without possessing legitimate user credentials.

Mechanically, the exploitation revolves around the misuse of forged authentication override cookies. When this feature is active, PAN-OS generates cookies to streamline subsequent user logins; however, due to the underlying flaw, an attacker can craft a fraudulent cookie specifically impersonating a local administrator account. By transmitting a single malicious HTTP request containing this forged cookie to the vulnerable GlobalProtect endpoint, the attacker completely bypasses the authentication gate. This immediately grants them an active, administrative VPN session, effectively placing them inside the organization's network perimeter with elevated privileges.

The real-world impact of CVE-2026-0257 is severe, as security researchers have documented distinct automated attack waves originating from infrastructure provider IP ranges targeting exposed systems. Because successful exploitation awards direct network access under an administrative context, threat actors can leverage this foothold as a precursor for lateral movement, data exfiltration, or the deployment of ransomware.

Affected Product

- PAN-OS devices running GlobalProtect portal and gateway with authentication override cookies enabled.

Impact

- Initial Access - Exploit Public-Facing Application (T1190)
- Credential Access / Defense Evasion - Adversary-in-the-Middle (T1539)
- Defense Evasion - Abuse Authentication Mechanism (T1556)
- Lateral Movement - Remote Services (T1021)

Vulnerabilities (CVEs)

CVE Number	Description	Published	CVSS Score
CVE-2026-0257	Authentication bypass vulnerabilities in the GlobalProtect portal and gateway of Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS software allows the attacker to bypass security restrictions and establish an unauthorized VPN connection.	6/8/2026	9.1

Remediation

- Organizations must immediately apply the official vendor patches released by Palo Alto Networks for affected versions of PAN-OS.
- If patching cannot be executed immediately, the primary temporary mitigation is to completely disable the "Authentication Override" feature within the GlobalProtect portal and gateway configuration settings, which effectively closes the specific attack vector.
- https://security.paloaltonetworks.com/CVE-2026-0257